



WEBINAR TIPS & TAKEAWAYS

Think 
College

Your Roadmap to Building Support for Inclusive College through Advocacy

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A simple four-step guide to help alliances, programs, and advocates expand inclusive college opportunities for students with intellectual disability.

Who This Is For

New or experienced advocates including members of state and regional alliances, college staff, and families who want to strengthen inclusive postsecondary education in their state.

Why It Matters

Inclusive postsecondary education opens doors to learning, friendships, independence, and jobs. This roadmap helps your team take practical steps to grow those opportunities—together.

1. Find Your People

Connect with others already working on inclusive college opportunities in your state. If no one is working, build a team of people invested in making this happen. Usually, this begins with college programs. You'll move faster and make a stronger impact by joining forces. Find your state or regional alliance on the [What's Happening in your State webpage](#). Reach out to the state contact, attend a meeting, and share your ideas. Stay in touch through regular calls or emails.

Tip: A united message speaks louder than many small ones.

2. Learn the Landscape

Work with your alliance to understand what's already happening in your state. Knowing the facts helps you see progress and pinpoint what's missing. Learn about existing programs by using the searchable program database at ThinkCollege.net/college-search. Also utilize the [State Legislation spreadsheet](#) to find this information and compare your state with others, then identify your key gaps and opportunities.

Example: We learned a neighboring state passed legislation to issue grants for colleges to start new inclusive programs.

If you missed the Policy & Advocacy webinar, you are in luck. [We recorded it and you can watch it FREE right here.](#)



State Policy Advocacy Resources

Use [Think College's collection of resources](#) to support state-level advocacy and education about college opportunities for students with intellectual disability.



Group of TCPA advocates and Liz Weintraub in front of US Capitol (2019).



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3. Share Your Story

Turn your knowledge into a story that inspires action. Share data and important facts. Stories make people care. Gather facts from every program in the state on enrollment, graduation, employment rates, and tuition costs. Then create a [one-page handout like this](#) with a summary of these data points, a student story, and a short message about why college matters for students with intellectual disability. Find your state legislators through [this official government website](#) and reach out: send an email, make a call, or invite them to visit your campus. Check out [these tools from Think College](#) to help guide your outreach.

Remember: Start small. One email, one meeting, one story—big change begins there.

4. Keep the Momentum Going

Stay connected and build on what you've started. Change takes time, and every step counts. Meet regularly with your state alliance to track progress and celebrate wins. Set one or two clear goals to start, such as increasing funding or creating new scholarships. Share updates with your network and keep in touch with your local representatives.

What can happen: After the senator learned about the benefits of college for students with intellectual disability, she visited our campus and later became a champion and helped fund two new scholarships in our state.

Need Help Getting Started?

Visit ThinkCollege.net for your state or regional alliance contact, college program listings, program data, policy resources and examples, and success stories from other states. You may also contact the Help Desk at Think College: ThinkCollegeTA@umb.edu.



TCPA team (2025) meets with Senator Kim from New Jersey.



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